
CGM

CHILTERN GARDEN MAINTENANCE

PREMIUM GARDEN GUIDE

Lawn Care Guide

Reseed, recover and maintain a Chilterns lawn

Price: £12.99 - £19.99

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Introduction

This guide covers everything you need to know about maintaining a healthy lawn in the Chilterns and Thames Valley. The chalk and clay soils of our region create specific challenges that generic lawn care advice does not address. We cover soil preparation, seed selection, mowing heights through the year, scarification, aeration, overseeding, and pest/disease control.

Soil assessment

Before doing any lawn work, assess your soil. Chalk soils (pH 7.5-8.5) drain freely but need drought-tolerant seed mixes. Clay soils (pH 6.0-7.0) retain water but need annual aeration to prevent compaction. Use a soil pH kit to test - they cost under £10 and give results in minutes.

Seed selection

For chalk soils: choose fescue-dominant mixes (50% slender creeping red fescue, 30% chewings fescue, 20% perennial ryegrass). For clay soils: choose ryegrass-dominant mixes (60% perennial ryegrass, 25% fescue, 15% bentgrass). For shade: use shade-tolerant fescue mixes with a minimum of 40% fescue content.

Mowing heights

Spring: 35-40mm. Summer: 25-30mm. Autumn: 35-40mm. Winter: do not mow unless ground is firm and frost-free. Never remove more than 1/3 of the grass blade in a single cut.

Scarification and aeration

Scarify annually in September or October when the soil is warm and moist. Aerate at the same time using a hollow-tine aerator. Apply top dressing (70% sand, 30% loam) at 2-3kg per square metre. Overseed immediately after with the appropriate seed mix at 25g per square metre.

Common problems

Moss: caused by compaction, shade, or acidic soil. Fix the cause, not the symptom. Weeds: dig out by hand or use a selective weedkiller. Leatherjackets: use biological control (nematodes) in September. Red thread: apply nitrogen feed. Fairy rings: aerate and apply a wetting agent.

About CGM

Chiltern Garden Maintenance (CGM) operates across Oxfordshire, Buckinghamshire, Berkshire and Bedfordshire. We deliver garden clearance, regular maintenance, lawn recovery, hedge cutting, fencing, soft landscaping, pressure washing, garden design and garden analysis reports. Visit chilterngardenmaintenance.com for more.